

Technology Board Report - May 2026

Director of Technology – Steven Hopper

This month's report will be brief, as I plan to be in attendance at our May meeting to answer any questions that may come up during the public hearing regarding our Internet Safety Plan. As a reminder, the purpose of our public hearing is to ensure compliance with the Children's Internet Protection Act (CIPA) which states the following:

*Schools and libraries subject to CIPA may not receive the discounts offered by the E-rate program unless they certify that they have an Internet safety policy that includes technology protection measures. The protection measures must block or filter Internet access to pictures that are: (a) obscene; (b) child pornography; or (c) harmful to minors (for computers that are accessed by minors). Before adopting this Internet safety policy, schools and libraries must **provide reasonable notice and hold at least one public hearing or meeting to address the proposal.***

It's highly likely that the district held a similar public hearing in the early 2000s after CIPA was passed, but as we could find no evidence of this hearing in our electronic files, we wanted to get one on the books. No board action is necessary unless you wish to make changes to policies 605.06 and 713, which we plan to adopt as our Internet Safety Plan.

The other item on your agenda this month will be approval of our 2026-2027 Chromebook refresh. We had an incredible 22 bids – a new record for me – and are currently evaluating proposals. Unfortunately, prices have gone up across the board last year due, in part, to chip shortages on the market. What we purchased last year for \$308/unit would now have been over \$450/unit on a comparable model. As a result, we've made some changes to try and bring the overall cost of the project down including transitioning from a 2-in-1 convertible laptop to a touchscreen "clamshell" (no tablet mode) and reducing the number of devices we order from 900 to 800 (due to enrollment changes in the grades scheduled for the next refresh). I'm happy to answer any questions at the board table on Monday. Thanks again for your continued support, and please reach out with any questions. Thank you.